



EXAM PREPARATIONS

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY FOR IT PROFESSIONALS

LECTURE SIX 9 & 10 MARCH 2020

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LEARNING OUTCOMES & ASSESSMENTS

- All assessments are linked to the learning outcomes of the subject
 - What are the learning outcomes for the subject? (p2 subject guide)
 - What learning outcomes do you have to demonstrate for a specific assessment? (p8 subject guide)

LEARNING OUTCOMES & ASSESSMENTS

No	Semester	ASSESSMENT TYPE and DESCRIPTION
	ONE	CLOSED BOOK TEST (10%)
		• What are the characteristics of academic/scientific research? • Distinctions between academic and other forms of research • Research process • Activities associated with research • Different types of research • What is ethical research practice
	ASSESSMENT CRITERIA Test Memo	LEARNING OUTCOMES 4

• Learning Outcomes

- Propose, design and conduct a small-scale research investigation, located within the IT professional context using basic questionnaire design
- Produce and create various communication documents (written, oral, visual) that demonstrate appropriate academic conventions and practices
- Exemplify appropriate ethical standards/values associated with academic research
- Describe, illustrate and examine at an introductory level the different methodologies, methods, processes, procedures and techniques associated with legitimate academic/scientific research

ASSESSMENT STRATEGIES - OVERVIEW

Semester	Types of Assessment	Nature of Assessment	Assessment Weight
ONE	1. Close-book exam	Individual	10
	2. Written research proposal	PAIRS	30
TWO	3. Research Report (part 1 & 2)	PAIRS	Part 1 = 20 Part 2 = 20
	4. Research Presentation	PAIRS	10
	5. Reflective piece (2)	Individual	10

EXAM 'CONTENT'

- What content/topics have we covered over the past five lecture sessions?
 - Overview of weekly lesson topics (see Blackboard for updated list)
 - Content Topics and Specific lesson topics(p 3 subject guide)
- Focus on
 - Topics/content not only WHAT was presented in lecture slides
 - Topic/content description includes **all READINGS** allocated to a specific topic/content area
 - Weekly reading tasks presented at the end of each lecture
 - Check the revised **Overview of Weekly Lesson Topics** on Blackboard

Week	Dates	Lesson Topic or Learning Activity	Readings
TERM 1			
1	3 - 7 Feb	Welcome and orientation to subject (What do researchers 'look like and do?')	Subject Guide
2	9 - 13 Feb	What is research? Nature of academic research	Booth et al (2016) Chapter 1
3	16 - 20 Feb	What is research? Characteristics and types of research	Kumar (2011) - Chapter 1
4	23 - 27 Feb	Research activities – processes, procedures and activities associated with research	Blaxter et al (2006) Chapter 1 Kumar (2011) Chapter 2
5	2 - 6 Mar	Conducting ethical research. Becoming an ethical researcher	Terre Blanche et al (2006) Chapter 4 Kumar – Chapter 14 Booth et al (2016) The Ethics of research
6	9 - 13 Mar	EXAM PREP	
7	16 - 20 Mar	TEST WEEK	

PRIORITY AREAS – WHAT THE LECTURES FOCUSED ON

Lecture 1	Lecture 2	Lecture 3	Lecture 4	Lecture 5
?	?	?	?	?

- List the main topics/focus areas for each lecture
- What points were given priority?
- What topic areas or specific focus points in the readings were given attention in class?
- What topic areas were given attention in the homework , reading or preparation tasks?

AREAS OF CONCERN

- Which topic areas are still causing concern?



FORMAT OF THE EXAM

- 10% of overall assessment total
- CLOSED book – no books, resources or notes allowed into exam venue
- 1 hour in duration (you are not allowed to leave the venue in first 30 minutes)
- 50 marks
- SUBJECT code and PART or FULL TIME status are all VERY IMPORTANT information
 - **MUST list this on your answer book**
- Covers all content allocated to TERM ONE (see subject guide & Blackboard)
- READ the questions carefully

FORMAT OF THE EXAM

- READ instructions carefully – FOLLOW instructions carefully
- Three (3) Sections and total of 9 questions
 - A = 15 marks
 - B = 25 marks
 - C = 10 marks
- Answer all questions in Sections A & B (Q 1-7), choice in C (either Q 8 or Q 9)
- Mostly short-answer questions (Section A & B)
- Case Study Application in Section C.
 - Short description of a research study, then respond to questions about case study. Provide details and use examples from case to illustrate your points

CASE STUDY EXAMPLES

ONE

- South Africa held its general election in May 2019. You are part of a research team wanting to find out whether South Africa voters still support the political party they voted for and whether or not they may or may not have shifted their opinions.
 - What 'tool' would you use to help you outline and describe the type of research you would undertake?
 - Describe the proposed type of research you would conduct to address the above research problem.

TWO

- Vodacom is interested in how high school learners (13 – 18 year olds) gain access to the internet and which apps they mostly use for social media. This is part of their drive to increase their market share in South Africa. You are part of a research team approached to design a research study to address these questions.
 - What are the ethical concerns that your team will have to address?
 - Who are the stakeholder you have to consider?

good
luck
in your
exams

